

Indian Premier League

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Indian Premier League: Research Report

Overview

The Indian Premier League (IPL) is a professional Twenty20 cricket league featuring 10 teams competing in a structured tournament format. It represents one of the world's premier cricket competitions, combining elite athleticism with significant commercial appeal.

Main Rules and Format

- **Twenty20 Format:** Cricket matches follow the T20 structure, focusing on faster-paced gameplay
- **Salary Cap:** Teams operate under a salary cap of ₹120 crore per squad
- **Player Restrictions:** Teams cannot select under-19 players without prior first-class or List A cricket experience
- **Trading Windows:** Player trading is permitted only during designated trading windows
- **Code of Conduct:** Compliance with International Cricket Council's Code of Conduct regulations used for T20 International matches as of 2025

IPL Teams and Competition

The league features multiple franchise teams competing annually. While specific team rosters vary by season, comprehensive information about competing teams and their historical achievements is available through official IPL resources that track team performance, player acquisitions, and tournament results.

Player Earnings and Auction System

- **Earning Variations:** IPL player compensation varies significantly based on player category and experience level
- **2025 Trends:** Indian players received larger paychecks during 2025 auctions compared to previous years
- **Overseas Player Cap:** Overseas players face an effective earnings cap of approximately \$22 million as of 2026

- **Auction Mechanism:** The IPL uses a mega auction system where teams select players according to established salary structures and auction rules
- **Salary Structure:** The governing body establishes auction regulations to manage player compensation across different categories

Key Takeaways

The IPL combines structured regulatory frameworks with competitive talent acquisition through its auction system. The league carefully balances player compensation between domestic and international cricketers while maintaining financial sustainability through salary caps and controlled trading mechanisms.

Sources

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